

CONSORTIUM ELEARNING NETWORK PVT. LTD.

STM Digital Library · journalslibrary.com

Open Access Compliance, Content Attribution & Rights-Holder Policy

A statement of the legal basis on which the Platform aggregates, attributes and provides access to scholarly content — and of the rights available to any author, publisher or rights holder who objects to that access.

Document Title	Open Access Compliance, Content Attribution & Rights-Holder Policy
Operator	Consortium eLearning Network Pvt. Ltd. (“CELNET”, “the Company”)
Platform	STM Digital Library, accessible at https://journalslibrary.com
Registered Office	New Delhi, India
Operations Address	A-118, 1st Floor, Sector 63, Noida, Uttar Pradesh — 201301, India
GSTIN	09AACCC6494M1Z1
Rights & Takedown Contact	info@celnet.in +91-9810078958 0120-4781200 / 0120-4781206
Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____ (to be entered on adoption)
Review Cycle	Annual, or upon any material change in sourcing practice or applicable law
Governing Law	Laws of India; exclusive jurisdiction of the competent courts at Delhi
Approved By	_____ (Director / Authorised Signatory)

IMPORTANT — READ BEFORE ADOPTION.

This document has been prepared as a working draft for the Company. It has **not** been settled by a practising advocate and does not constitute legal advice. Sections 9.5, 10 and 15 in particular make representations about the Company’s systems and about Indian statutory provisions that must be verified by qualified counsel, and the operational commitments in Sections 6, 9 and 11 must be confirmed as actually implemented before this document is published or relied upon. A published policy that the Company cannot demonstrate compliance with is a liability, not a protection.

Contents

1. Purpose and Scope of this Policy
2. Identity of the Operator
3. What the Platform Is — and What It Is Not
4. Categories of Content on the Platform
5. How Open Access Content Is Sourced
6. Attribution and Non-Misrepresentation
7. No Claim of Ownership
8. Basis of Charging: Fees Are for the Software, Not the Content
9. Licence Compliance Framework
10. Legal Framework Relied Upon
11. Rights-Holder Objection and Takedown Policy
12. Publisher Partnership and Standing Opt-Out
13. Records, Audit Trail and Transparency Reporting
14. Grievance Officer and Nodal Contact
15. Disclaimer and Limitation of Liability
16. Governing Law and Jurisdiction
17. Amendment and Version Control

Annexure A — Content Removal / Takedown Request Form

Annexure B — Declaration of Authority (Authorised Representative)

Annexure C — Counter-Notice / Restoration Request Form

Annexure D — Internal Handling Standard Operating Procedure

1. Purpose and Scope of this Policy

This Policy sets out, openly and without reservation, the basis on which STM Digital Library (“the Platform”) makes scholarly content available to its users. It is published so that any author, journal, publisher, repository, funder or institution can see precisely what the Platform does with third-party material, what it charges for, what it does not claim, and how it can be required to stop.

The Company’s position is stated plainly rather than buried: the Platform aggregates Open Access scholarly material that is already lawfully and freely available to the public; it does not present that material as its own; it attributes every item to the journal and publisher that produced it; it charges its subscribers for the software and services it has built, not for the underlying scholarship; and it will remove any item on the request of the rights holder, without requiring that rights holder to litigate, prove infringement, or explain themselves at length.

This Policy applies to all content made accessible through the Platform and to all subscribers, institutional users and visitors. It supplements, and must be read together with, the Platform’s Terms & Conditions, Privacy Policy, Legal Disclaimer and Content Sources & Licensing statement. Where a conflict arises between this Policy and any of those documents on the subject of third-party content rights, this Policy prevails.

2. Identity of the Operator

The Platform is owned and operated by **Consortium eLearning Network Pvt. Ltd.**, a company incorporated under the Companies Act with its registered office at New Delhi, India, and its principal place of operations at A-118, 1st Floor, Sector 63, Noida, Uttar Pradesh — 201301, India (GSTIN 09AACCC6494M1Z1).

The Company operates a number of publishing divisions, imprints and sister concerns, including STM Journals, JournalsPub, Law Journals and MBA Journals. Content originating from those divisions is the Company’s own proprietary content. Content originating from any other source is third-party content and is treated as such throughout this Policy.

3. What the Platform Is — and What It Is Not

3.1 What the Platform is

The Platform is a **software and technology service**. Its subject matter is the problem of finding, filtering, organising and reading scholarly material at scale. What the Company has built and owns is the software: the harvesting and de-duplication pipeline, the normalised metadata index, the department- and subject-level classification, the cascading discovery filters, the secure in-application reader, the institutional access and entitlement management system, the usage analytics, and the administrative tooling that keeps all of it running.

3.2 What the Platform is not

The Platform is **not** a publisher of third-party works. It does not commission, peer-review, edit, typeset, brand or assert editorial control over third-party scholarship. It does not sell third-party articles. It does not represent that it holds a licence from every rights holder whose Open Access work is discoverable through it, and it has never done

so. It is not the source of record for any third-party work; the source of record is, and remains, the publisher's own site of publication, identified on the Platform by DOI wherever a DOI exists.

The distinction that matters. A subscriber who cancels their subscription loses access to the Company's software. They do not lose access to the underlying Open Access scholarship, which remains freely available to them — as it was before, and as it will be after — at the publisher's own website. The Platform's subscription has never been the thing standing between a reader and an Open Access article.

4. Categories of Content on the Platform

Every record on the Platform is classified at the point of entry into one of the following categories, and that classification is stored against the record and is auditable.

Category	Origin	Treatment
Proprietary content	The Company's own divisions, imprints and sister concerns	Owned by the Company. May be offered on a subscription or fee basis as the Company's own product.
Publisher-submitted content	Third-party publishers who have entered into a partnership with the Company	Supplied and controlled by the publisher under an agreement, through the Platform's publisher portal. The publisher may withdraw it at any time from their own dashboard.
Harvested Open Access content	Public Open Access indexes and repositories (see Section 5)	Not owned by the Company. Attributed to the originating journal and publisher. Subject in full to the takedown rights in Section 11.
Metadata-only records	As above, where no Open Access full text is available to the Platform	Bibliographic metadata and abstract only. No full text is served. The reader is directed to the DOI and to the publisher's own site.

5. How Open Access Content Is Sourced

5.1 Sources

Harvested content is obtained through the public application programming interfaces of established scholarly infrastructure services, namely **OpenAlex**, the **Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ)** and **arXiv**. The Company does not scrape publisher websites, does not circumvent paywalls, does not use credentials belonging to any institution or individual to obtain content, and does not obtain content from unauthorised or "shadow" repositories.

5.2 Open Access filtering at source

Harvesting queries are constrained at the API level to works that are marked as Open Access. In the case of OpenAlex, the query filter applied is `open_access.is_oa:true` together with `has_doi:true`, so that only Open Access works carrying a persistent identifier enter the pipeline. Works that are not marked Open Access at source are never requested and never enter the index.

5.3 Full text is streamed, not stored

This is a material feature of the Platform's design and of its legal position. Where an Open Access full text is made available to a reader, the Platform **does not hold a copy of it**. The file is requested from the originating host at the moment the reader opens it, and streamed through to the reader's browser. Nothing is retained afterwards. The Platform's storage contains bibliographic metadata and a pointer; it does not contain a library of third-party PDFs.

Consequently, the Platform's handling of third-party full text is transient and incidental storage for the purpose of providing access, and not the making or distribution of copies. This is directly relevant to Section 10.1 below.

5.4 Restricted host allow-list

Full text is streamed only from an explicit allow-list of Open Access-native hosts — including arXiv, bioRxiv, medRxiv, BioMed Central, PLOS, Frontiers, eLife, PeerJ, eScholarship, F1000Research, Copernicus, SciELO and J-STAGE. Any link that resolves to a host outside that allow-list is not streamed. Records whose full text cannot be served in this way are retained as metadata-only records under Section 4, with the reader directed to the publisher.

6. Attribution and Non-Misrepresentation

The Company undertakes the following, and these undertakings are enforceable against it by any rights holder relying on this Policy.

1. **Every record carries its origin.** For each third-party item the Platform stores and displays the author names, the journal or source title, the ISSN where available, the publishing organisation, the volume, issue, pages and year of publication, and the DOI.
2. **The publisher's name is shown, not the Company's.** Third-party content is displayed under the name of the journal and publisher that produced it. The Company does not substitute its own name, logo or imprint for that of the originating publisher, and does not present third-party scholarship as having been published by the Company or any of its divisions.
3. **No re-branding, no watermarking, no alteration.** Third-party full text is served exactly as it is received from the originating host. The Company does not overlay its branding on it, does not re-typeset it, and does not create derivative versions of it.
4. **Attribution is not conditional on subscription.** Attribution metadata is shown to every visitor, including those with no subscription and those who are not signed in.
5. **The DOI is a route out, not a dead end.** Where a DOI exists it is displayed and is resolvable, so that a reader can always reach the publisher's own site of publication directly.

7. No Claim of Ownership

The Company does not claim, and expressly disclaims, any ownership of, or exclusive right in, any third-party content made available through or referenced on the Platform. All such content remains the intellectual property of its respective authors, publishers, licensors and rights holders. Inclusion of an item on the Platform does not imply ownership, endorsement, affiliation, sponsorship or any exclusive right on the part of the Company. Any right not expressly granted to the Company by a rights holder is reserved to that rights holder.

Nothing on the Platform, and nothing in the Company's marketing, should be read as a claim that the Company owns the scholarly corpus it indexes. Where any such impression has been created, whether by wording, layout or emphasis, the Company will correct it on being notified.

8. Basis of Charging: Fees Are for the Software, Not the Content

8.1 The consideration

Subscription and licence fees payable to the Company are consideration for access to the Company's software and services. They are not, and have never been presented as, the purchase price of any third-party article, chapter or dataset.

What the subscriber is paying for is:

- a normalised, de-duplicated and continuously maintained index across a very large number of sources, which the subscriber would otherwise have to assemble and maintain themselves;
- subject and departmental classification, and the cascading journal → year → volume → issue discovery filters built on top of it;
- a secure in-application reader, including streaming of large documents;
- institutional access management — entitlements by department and content type, user provisioning, suspension, and IP-based and credential-based authentication;
- usage analytics, reading history, favourites and continuity of reading across devices;
- administrative tooling for librarians, and support, hosting, uptime and maintenance.

8.2 What the fee is not

- It is not a fee for the right to read any Open Access article. That right is granted by the article's own licence, directly to the reader, by the rights holder — not by the Company.
- It does not create exclusivity. The Company does not restrict, and cannot restrict, anyone's access to Open Access content at its original source.
- It does not place Open Access content behind a paywall. Content that is Open Access at source remains Open Access at source, unaffected by anything the Company does.
- It is not shared with, and does not create any revenue-sharing obligation to, third-party rights holders in respect of harvested Open Access content — because it is not a fee for that content.

8.3 Non-commercial licences

The Company recognises that the distinction drawn in this Section is not by itself a complete answer where a work is licensed on non-commercial terms. Its commitments in that regard are set out in Section 9.3 and are operational, not merely declaratory.

9. Licence Compliance Framework

9.1 Principle

Open Access does not mean unconditional. Each Open Access work carries a licence, and the licence governs what may be done with the work. The Company's obligation is to honour the licence attaching to each item, not merely the fact that the item is Open Access.

9.2 Treatment by licence family

Licence	Treatment on the Platform
CC BY	Indexed and streamed with full attribution as required by the licence. Attribution is rendered as set out in Section 6.
CC BY-SA	Indexed and streamed with attribution. The Platform creates no adaptations, so the share-alike obligation is not engaged.
CC BY-ND	Indexed and streamed unmodified, with attribution. No derivative, abridged, re-typeset or re-formatted version is created or served.
CC BY-NC and CC BY-NC-ND / NC-SA	Excluded from paid tiers. Not to be made available as part of any subscription or fee-bearing service, unless the rights holder has expressly permitted it in writing. See Section 9.3.
CC0 / Public Domain	Indexed and streamed. Attribution is nevertheless displayed as a matter of scholarly practice.
Bespoke or unclear licence	Treated as restricted. Held as a metadata-only record under Section 4 until the licence is positively established.

9.3 The non-commercial commitment

Content carrying a non-commercial restriction will not be included within a paid service of the Company unless the rights holder has expressly permitted that use. Where such content is identified within a paid tier, it will be removed from that tier promptly on identification, whether the identification is made by the Company or is notified by a third party.

9.4 Derivative works

The Company does not create derivative works from third-party content. It does not translate, summarise for republication, abridge, re-typeset, or generate new works from third-party full text. Machine processing performed by the Company is confined to indexing, classification and de-duplication, and its output is bibliographic metadata rather than a substitute for the work.

9.5 Current implementation status — stated candidly

The Company records that, as at the date of this version, the Platform's ingestion pipeline captures bibliographic metadata but **does not yet capture and store the licence identifier of each harvested item**. In consequence, the commitments in Sections 9.2 and 9.3 are presently given effect through source-level and host-level controls (Sections 5.2 and 5.4) and through responsive removal on notice (Section 11), rather than through per-item licence verification.

The Company undertakes to implement per-item licence capture and to apply the classification in the table at Section 9.2 automatically at the point of ingestion. Until that is completed, any rights holder who considers that a work of theirs carrying a non-commercial or other restrictive licence has been included in a paid tier is invited to notify the Company under Section 11, and the item will be removed without the Company requiring any further proof.

This paragraph is included deliberately. A policy that overstates the maturity of the controls behind it is worse than no policy, because the overstatement is itself actionable. The Company prefers to state the position accurately and to close the gap.

10. Legal Framework Relied Upon

The following is a statement of the framework within which the Company operates. It is a summary for the reader's orientation and is subject to confirmation by counsel; it is not a legal opinion.

10.1 The Copyright Act, 1957

Section 52 of the Copyright Act, 1957 sets out acts that do not constitute infringement. Section 52(1)(c) addresses transient or incidental storage of a work for the purpose of providing electronic links, access or integration, where such access has not been expressly prohibited by the rights holder, and where the person responsible is not aware and has no reasonable ground for believing that the stored copy is infringing. Given the design described in Section 5.3 — streaming from the originating Open Access host without retention — the Company's handling of third-party full text is intended to fall within this provision.

The proviso to Section 52(1)(c) prescribes the mechanism that follows a complaint: on receipt of a written complaint from the owner of copyright, the person responsible for the storage must refrain from facilitating access **for twenty-one days**, or until receipt of an order of a competent court. If no such order is received within that period, access may be resumed. The procedural requirements for such a complaint are set out in the Copyright Rules, 2013. The Company's takedown procedure at Section 11 is built around this mechanism, and is deliberately more generous to the complainant than the statute requires.

10.2 The Information Technology Act, 2000

The Company operates the Platform as an intermediary within the meaning of Section 2(1)(w) of the Information Technology Act, 2000, insofar as it provides access to third-party material. Section 79 affords an intermediary exemption from liability in respect of third-party information, subject to the conditions stated in that section — including that the intermediary observes due diligence, does not initiate or select the receiver of the transmission or select or modify the information, and expeditiously removes or disables access to material on receiving actual knowledge, or on being notified by the appropriate Government or its agency.

The Company accordingly does not modify third-party content (Section 6, item 3), does not select recipients, and maintains the notice-and-action machinery at Section 11.

10.3 The Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code Rules, 2021

The Company observes the due diligence obligations applicable to intermediaries under these Rules, including publication of its rules, privacy policy and user agreement; appointment of a Grievance Officer whose name and contact details are published (Section 14); acknowledgement of a complaint within **twenty-four hours** and its disposal within **fifteen days** of receipt; and removal or disabling of access within **thirty-six hours** of actual knowledge in the form of a court order or a notification by the appropriate Government or its agency. The Company is not a significant social media intermediary and the additional obligations applicable to such intermediaries are not engaged.

10.4 The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023

Personal data processed by the Platform — including subscriber account data, institutional user records and usage logs — is handled in accordance with the Company's Privacy Policy and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. This Policy is concerned with content rights and does not displace the Privacy Policy.

10.5 Complainants outside India

The Company will accept and act on a notice from a rights holder situated in any jurisdiction, and does not require the complainant to establish a connection with India. A notice framed in the form customary in the complainant's own jurisdiction — including a notice in the form contemplated by 17 U.S.C. §512(c)(3) — will be accepted and acted upon under Section 11, provided it contains the information at Section 11.3.

11. Rights-Holder Objection and Takedown Policy

11.1 The commitment, stated first

If you are the author, publisher, or rights holder of a work that appears on this Platform, and you do not want it there, **tell us and we will take it down.** You do not need to prove infringement. You do not need to instruct a lawyer. You do not need to explain your reasons. You do not need to threaten proceedings. One email to **info@celnet.in**, or one completed form, is enough.

11.2 Who may object

A request may be made by: the author of the work; the publisher, journal or learned society in which it appeared; the institution or repository that hosts it; a funder with rights in it; an assignee or exclusive licensee; or any person duly authorised to act on behalf of any of the foregoing. Where the request is made by a representative, Annexure B should accompany it.

11.3 What a request should contain

To allow the Company to identify the material and act on it, a request should state:

1. the name, organisation, postal address, email address and telephone number of the person making the request;
2. the capacity in which the request is made (author, publisher, assignee, authorised representative, or otherwise);
3. sufficient particulars to identify the material — the title, the DOI where one exists, and the URL on the Platform where the material appears. A list may be annexed where several items are concerned, and a journal or ISSN may be given instead where the request concerns an entire title;
4. the relief sought — removal of full-text access, removal of the record in its entirety, correction of attribution, or a standing exclusion of the title going forward;
5. a statement that the requester believes in good faith that they are entitled to make the request; and
6. the requester's signature, whether physical or electronic.

A reason for the request is welcome but **is not required**. The Company will not decline to act on a request merely because no reason has been given, nor because the requester has not asserted infringement.

11.4 How to send it

Channel	Details
Email	info@celnet.in — subject line “Content Removal Request”. The preferred channel.
Online form	The takedown request form published on the Platform. Annexure A sets out the fields it collects.
Post	The Grievance Officer, Consortium eLearning Network Pvt. Ltd., A-118, 1st Floor, Sector 63, Noida, Uttar Pradesh — 201301, India
Telephone	0120-4781200 / 0120-4781206, or +91-9810078958 — to be followed by a written request for the record.

11.5 What happens, and when

Stage	Time limit	Action
Acknowledgement	Within 24 hours of receipt	A written acknowledgement is issued with a reference number.

Interim suspension	Within 72 hours of receipt	Where the material is identifiable from the request, access to the full text is suspended immediately, pending review. The Company suspends first and reviews afterwards; it does not require the requester to wait for the review to conclude.
Review and decision	Within 7 working days	The request is reviewed, the decision recorded, and the requester informed in writing.
Full disposal	Within 15 days	The complaint is disposed of in accordance with Rule 3(2) of the Intermediary Guidelines, 2021.
Court or Government order	Within 36 hours	Material is removed or disabled on receipt of an order of a competent court or a notification by the appropriate Government or its agency.
Standing exclusion	On the same decision	Where requested, the title, ISSN or publisher is added to a permanent exclusion list so that the material is not re-acquired by a subsequent harvest.

11.6 Scope of removal

Unless the requester specifies otherwise, removal means that full-text access through the Platform ceases and the record is delisted from search and browse. Where the requester asks for complete erasure, the record is deleted. Where the requester asks only that attribution be corrected, the record is corrected and retained. The requester chooses; the Company does not choose for them.

11.7 Standing exclusion and no re-acquisition

A rights holder may ask to be excluded from the Platform permanently and in advance, without identifying particular items. On such a request the journal, ISSN or publisher is placed on an exclusion list which is applied to every subsequent harvest, so that the material does not reappear. This is available on request at any time and requires no reason.

11.8 Restoration

Material removed under this Section is restored only if the rights holder who requested its removal asks for it to be restored, or if a person entitled to do so establishes that the removal request was made without authority. The procedure is at Annexure C.

11.9 No retaliation, no cost

The Company will not charge any fee for processing a request, will not require a requester to enter into any agreement as a condition of removal, and will not treat the making of a request as a reason to decline any future dealing with the requester.

12. Publisher Partnership and Standing Opt-Out

A publisher whose material is discoverable through the Platform has, at all times, three options, and may move between them freely:

1. **Take no action.** The material continues to be indexed with attribution under this Policy.
2. **Opt out.** The material is removed and the title is placed on the exclusion list under Section 11.7. No reason is required and no cost is incurred.
3. **Partner.** The publisher takes a login to the Platform's publisher portal, from which it can submit and manage its own content, control what is published, correct metadata, see readership analytics for its own titles, and withdraw any item at any time without going through the Company.

The partnership option is offered on its merits. It is not a condition of removal, and a publisher who declines it is not thereby disadvantaged in any way in the handling of a removal request.

13. Records, Audit Trail and Transparency Reporting

The Company maintains, for each item of third-party content, a record of the source from which it was acquired, the date of acquisition, the classification applied under Section 4, and the identity of the originating journal and publisher. For each request received under Section 11, the Company maintains a record of the request, the date of receipt, the action taken, the date of that action and the identity of the officer who took it. These records are retained for not less than five years.

The Company intends to publish a periodic transparency report stating the number of removal requests received, the number acted upon, and the median time to action.

14. Grievance Officer and Nodal Contact

In accordance with Rule 3(2) of the Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code Rules, 2021, the following officer is designated to receive and dispose of complaints, including complaints under this Policy.

Name	_____
Designation	Grievance Officer, Consortium eLearning Network Pvt. Ltd.
Email	info@celnet.in
Telephone	0120-4781200 / 0120-4781206
Address	A-118, 1st Floor, Sector 63, Noida, Uttar Pradesh — 201301, India
Hours	Monday to Friday, 10:00 to 18:00 IST, excluding public holidays

The name of the Grievance Officer must be completed and published on the Platform before this Policy is relied upon. Rule 3(2)(a) requires the name *and* contact details to be published; a generic mailbox alone does not discharge the obligation.

15. Disclaimer and Limitation of Liability

The Platform makes no representation or warranty as to the completeness, accuracy, currency or continued availability of third-party content. Third-party content is provided as it is received from its source. The Company does not endorse the content of any third-party work, and the appearance of a work on the Platform is not a statement about its quality, validity or standing.

Users are responsible for ensuring that their own use of any content obtained through the Platform — including copying, redistribution, text and data mining, and inclusion in their own works — complies with the licence attaching to that content and with applicable law. The Company's provision of access does not enlarge the rights granted to the user by the applicable licence.

To the fullest extent permitted by law, the Company shall not be liable for any indirect, incidental, special or consequential loss arising from the use of, reliance upon, or inability to access third-party content through the Platform. Nothing in this Section limits any liability which cannot lawfully be limited.

16. Governing Law and Jurisdiction

This Policy and any dispute arising out of or in connection with it shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India. The competent courts at Delhi, India shall have exclusive jurisdiction. Nothing in this Section prevents a rights holder from making a request under Section 11 from any jurisdiction, or requires them to submit to the jurisdiction of the Indian courts in order to have their material removed.

17. Amendment and Version Control

This Policy may be amended by the Company. The version number and effective date on the cover page identify the operative version, and superseded versions are retained by the Company. Where an amendment materially reduces the rights available to rights holders under Section 11, the Company will publish notice of the amendment on the Platform not less than thirty days before it takes effect.

End of Policy. Annexures A to D follow and form part of this document.

ANNEXURE A

Content Removal / Takedown Request Form

Complete and send to **info@celnet.in** (subject: “Content Removal Request”) or by post to The Grievance Officer, Consortium eLearning Network Pvt. Ltd., A-118, 1st Floor, Sector 63, Noida, Uttar Pradesh — 201301, India. You will receive an acknowledgement with a reference number within 24 hours. **You are not required to state a reason, and you are not required to allege infringement.** Fields marked * are needed only so that we can identify the material and reply to you.

Part 1 — About you

FULL NAME ***ORGANISATION / PUBLISHER****EMAIL ADDRESS *****TELEPHONE****POSTAL ADDRESS****COUNTRY**

Part 2 — Your capacity

Tick whichever applies.

- ☐ I am the author of the work
- ☐ I am the publisher / journal / learned society
- ☐ I am the repository or institution hosting the work
- ☐ I am the assignee or exclusive licensee of the rights
- ☐ I am authorised to act on behalf of the rights holder (please also complete Annexure B)
- ☐ Other — please specify:

Part 3 — The material

TITLE(S) OF THE WORK *

If several items are concerned, attach a list and write “see attached list”.

DOI (IF ANY)

JOURNAL / BOOK TITLE

ISSN / ISBN

YEAR OF PUBLICATION

URL ON JOURNALLIBRARY.COM *

The page where the material appears. If you cannot find it, describe the material and we will locate it for you.

Part 4 — What you want us to do

- ☐ **Remove the full text** — stop serving the document, keep the bibliographic record
- ☐ **Remove the record entirely** — delete the listing from the Platform
- ☐ **Correct the attribution** — the record is misattributed; details below
- ☐ **Standing exclusion** — remove this material and do not acquire any content from this journal / ISSN / publisher in future
- ☐ **Remove from paid tiers only** — the work carries a non-commercial licence

DETAILS, IF ANY

Part 5 — Reason (optional)

REASON FOR THE REQUEST — OPTIONAL

You may leave this blank. We will act on your request either way.

Part 6 — Declaration

- ☐ I believe in good faith that I am entitled to make this request in the capacity stated at Part 2.
- ☐ The information I have given in Parts 1 and 3 is accurate to the best of my knowledge.
- ☐ I consent to the Company retaining this request and the details in it for the purpose of acting on it and of maintaining the record required by Section 13 of the Policy.

Signature	Name in block letters	Date
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Office use only — Reference no.: _____ Received on: _____ Acknowledged on: _____
Interim suspension applied on: _____ Decision on: _____ Officer: _____

ANNEXURE B

Declaration of Authority — Authorised Representative

To be completed only where the request at Annexure A is made by a person acting on behalf of the rights holder. It is not required where the requester is the author, the publisher, or the rights holder acting directly.

NAME OF THE RIGHTS HOLDER ON WHOSE BEHALF YOU ACT ***THEIR ADDRESS****YOUR NAME *****YOUR RELATIONSHIP TO THEM *****BASIS OF YOUR AUTHORITY ***

For example: in-house counsel; agent under a power of attorney; rights and permissions officer; instructed solicitor. Attach evidence if readily available — it is helpful but not a precondition to us acting.

- ☐ I confirm that I am duly authorised to make the request at Annexure A on behalf of the rights holder named above.
- ☐ I understand that the Company may act on this request without independently verifying my authority, and that the rights holder may seek restoration under Annexure C if the request was made without authority.

Signature

Name in block letters

Date

ANNEXURE C

Counter-Notice / Restoration Request Form

Use this form if material has been removed from the Platform and you wish it to be restored — because you are the rights holder and did not authorise its removal, or because you requested the removal yourself and have since changed your mind.

FULL NAME ***ORGANISATION****EMAIL ADDRESS *****TELEPHONE****REFERENCE NO. OF THE ORIGINAL REQUEST, IF KNOWN****APPROXIMATE DATE OF REMOVAL****MATERIAL CONCERNED — TITLE AND DOI *****Ground for restoration**

- ☐ I am the rights holder and I made the original removal request. I now withdraw it and ask that the material be restored.
- ☐ I am the rights holder. The removal request was made by a person who was not authorised to make it on my behalf.
- ☐ Other — please explain below.

EXPLANATION

- ☐ I believe in good faith that I am entitled to make this request and that the statements above are accurate.

Signature

Name in block letters

Date

The Company will not restore material at the request of a person other than the rights holder who requested its removal, unless that person establishes their entitlement to the satisfaction of the Grievance Officer.

ANNEXURE D

Internal Handling — Standard Operating Procedure

This Annexure is addressed to the Company's own staff. It is published so that a rights holder can see exactly what is supposed to happen to their request, and hold the Company to it.

Step	Owner	Deadline	Action
1	Grievance Officer	24 hours	Log the request in the takedown register. Allocate a reference number. Send written acknowledgement quoting that number.
2	Content Manager	72 hours	Locate the material from the particulars given. If it cannot be located, contact the requester for clarification — do not close the request. Suspend full-text access on identification.
3	Content Manager	7 working days	Determine the classification of the item under Section 4 and the relief sought under Part 4 of Annexure A. Apply the relief. Record what was done.
4	Content Manager	Same day as step 3	Where a standing exclusion is sought, add the journal, ISSN or publisher to the harvest exclusion list and verify that a subsequent harvest does not re-acquire the material.
5	Grievance Officer	15 days	Write to the requester confirming the action taken and close the request.
6	Grievance Officer	36 hours	Where the request arrives as an order of a competent court or a notification by the appropriate Government or its agency, remove or disable access within 36 hours of receipt, ahead of all other steps.
7	Grievance Officer	Quarterly	Report to the Board the number of requests received, actioned and outstanding, and the median time to action.

Standing instructions

- Do not ask a requester to prove infringement, to produce a chain of title, or to instruct a lawyer, as a condition of acting.
- Do not offer, suggest or imply that a partnership, subscription or commercial arrangement would avoid the need for removal.
- Do not delay a removal pending a commercial discussion of any kind.
- Where the request is ambiguous as to scope, apply the broader removal and tell the requester what was done, rather than applying the narrower removal and waiting.
- Escalate to a Director immediately where the request alleges bad faith, threatens proceedings, or comes from a regulator.

Register. The takedown register records, for each request: reference number; date received; requester and capacity; material concerned; relief sought; interim suspension date; decision; decision date; officer; and date closed. It is retained for not less than five years and is the evidence that this Policy is operated in practice rather than merely published.